



Drone rediscovers extinct flower

A drone has helped botanists in Hawaii to find a flower that they thought was extinct.
<https://digit.in/may19-11>



Greenland melting faster

The melting rate of ice from Greenland has already increased sea level significantly.
<https://digit.in/may19-12>



How to set-up an intercom for your building using an old smartphone

Necessity might be the mother of invention, but just sometimes an old spare phone gathering dust in your drawer coupled with a *jugaadu* mentality, might just be the push that is needed to get those innovation juices flowing.

Siddharth Parwatay |
feedback@digit.in

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hile necessity might be the mother of invention, no claims of innovation's parentage have yet

been put forth. Which brings us to the question: what sparks innovation? What does it take for people to go from

not fixing things which aren't broke to bringing out revolutionary (or not so revolutionary) transformations to things big and small? To things like say, even the humble intercom system.

The intercom system, as we know it, was first invented in the late 1930s – nearly 60 years after the invention of the telephone. Now about 70 years later, we're seeing the next step in its evolutionary journey – the advent of digital intercoms. Instead of setting up

intercoms using closed circuit internal telephone wiring, consumers are now moving towards using automated digital systems to boost efficiency, ease communication, as well as increase security. You can now get video calls from the gate when someone claims to be there on business for you, get automated alerts of when guests (or the household help) arrives or leaves even if you aren't at home, and do things like ask the guard to sign for a package for you, and so on, via the internet.

It's a niche and nascent market but one that's likely to see success once awareness increases, the technology matures and there are more solutions on offer. For the security conscious millennial, having their apartment clued into their phone is a very enticing proposition. Right now, from what we can gather, there are two major players in this visitor management space – MyGate and Apartment Adda. While they both have a few overlapping offerings, they each do have some unique USPs that appeal to specific customer needs. MyGate is primarily into recordkeeping, visitor management, child security and premises management. ApartmentAdda, on the other hand, seems to be focussing more on the community aspect with features such as hyperlocal classifieds, instant messaging and simplified monthly society maintenance payments and similar stuff.

As great and full-featured as these services might be, they might seem like overkill in a few cases. For instance, if you live in a small town or suburb and your apartment building comprises of no more than say a dozen households, you might have no need for this large bouquet of features. Your society probably barely agreed to put up the contribution for a security guard's salary, so chipping in for a landline based EPABX system is out of the question. And so would be the possibility of engaging one of the above app based solutions. Besides, the size of your apartment complex doesn't warrant complex record keeping and visitor management. All you want is a small